

# ENGLISH GRAMMAR & COMMUNICATION SKILLS

Complete Revision Notes

Grammar Concepts • TCS English Assessment Q&A • Practice Exercises with  
Answer Keys

PART I Grammar Concepts & Explanations

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PART II TCS English Assessment — Full Q&A with  
Passages

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PART III Practice Exercises (Fill in the Blanks) + Answer Keys

# Grammar Concepts & Explanations

Subject-verb agreement • Adjectives & adverbs • Concession words • Indianisms • Qualifiers • Quantifiers • Art

## 1. Subject–Verb Agreement — Practice Sets

Choose the correct verb form to agree with the subject. Answers are shown in green.

### Set 1

|                                                                     |           |      |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|------|
| Fish and chips _____ one of my favorite foods.                      | is / are  | is   |
| Everyone associated with this project _____ getting an award.       | is / are  | is   |
| Your trousers fit you well. Where did you get _____ tailored?       | it / them | them |
| One-fourth of the employees in this project _____ from North India. | is / are  | are  |
| Most of the work _____ completed.                                   | is / are  | is   |

### Set 2

|                                                                   |          |     |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|-----|
| The captain, as well as his team, _____ attending the press meet. | is / are | is  |
| Neither the PL nor the team members _____ coming to office today. | is / are | are |
| One of them _____ coming for the briefing.                        | is / are | is  |
| The audience _____ divided on their views. (American English)     | is / are | is  |
| The audience _____ divided on their views. (British English)      | is / are | are |

### Set 3

|                                                                 |          |         |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------|---------|
| The premises _____ right in the heart of the city.              | is / are | are     |
| There _____ several ways in which the problem can be addressed. | is / are | are     |
| Not one of them _____ present for the meeting.                  | is / are | is      |
| One of the taps in the washroom _____ leaking.                  | is / are | is      |
| The chocolates _____ enough; but, there _____ enough sugar.     | are / is | are, is |

### Set 4

|                                                                                                |              |      |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|------|
| A majority of employees _____ to move to a new location.                                       | want / wants | want |
| Most of my everyday tasks _____ routine.                                                       | is / are     | are  |
| The Learning and Development department in this company _____ located in a different building. | is / are     | is   |
| The staff _____ happy with the revised work hours. (American English)                          | is / are     | is   |

|                                                                      |          |     |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|-----|
| The staff _____ happy with the revised work hours. (British English) | is / are | are |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|-----|

## 2. Adjectives vs. Adverbs

**Adjective** — describes a noun (person, place, thing). Tells: what kind? which one? how many?

Examples: red car • happy child • three books

**Adverb** — describes a verb (action), an adjective, or another adverb. Tells: how? when? where? how much? Often ends in *-ly*.

Examples: She runs *quickly*. • He is *very* tall. • They arrived *yesterday*.

**Golden rule:** If a word describes a person/place/thing → Adjective. If it describes an action, or another describing word (an adjective/adverb) → Adverb.  
e.g. **much** better → "much" describes "better" (an adjective) → so **much is an adverb**.

| Sentence                   | Word describes... → Part of Speech           |
|----------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| She is a beautiful singer. | beautiful → singer (noun) → <b>Adjective</b> |
| She sings beautifully.     | beautifully → sings (verb) → <b>Adverb</b>   |
| She is very beautiful.     | very → beautiful (adjective) → <b>Adverb</b> |
| She is much better now.    | much → better (adjective) → <b>Adverb</b>    |

## 3. Concession Words

Concession words show **contrast** or an **unexpected result** — "Even though this is true, something else happened."

| Word         | Example                                |
|--------------|----------------------------------------|
| Although     | Although it was raining, we played.    |
| Though       | Though he is young, he is smart.       |
| Even though  | Even though she was tired, she worked. |
| While        | While I agree, I have doubts.          |
| Whereas      | He likes tea, whereas I like coffee.   |
| Despite      | Despite the rain, we went out.         |
| In spite of  | In spite of his age, he runs fast.     |
| However      | It was hard. However, we finished.     |
| Nevertheless | It was risky. Nevertheless, we tried.  |
| Nonetheless  | He was sick. Nonetheless, he came.     |
| Yet          | It was simple, yet effective.          |
| Still        | It was cold. Still, we enjoyed it.     |

**Quick trick:** If you can replace it with "but" or "even though" → it's a concession word.

## 4. Indianisms

Words/phrases that are grammatically unnatural in standard English but common in India, often due to direct translation from Hindi or other Indian languages.

| Indianism                | Correct English                              |
|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| What is your good name?  | What is your name?                           |
| I am having a headache.  | I have a headache.                           |
| Please do the needful.   | Please do what is necessary.                 |
| Revert back              | Revert ("back" is unnecessary)               |
| Out of station           | Out of town / away                           |
| Prepone                  | Bring forward / reschedule earlier / advance |
| Myself Ram               | I am Ram                                     |
| Your's faithfully        | Yours faithfully                             |
| I will come today only.  | I will come today.                           |
| We were three members.   | There were three of us.                      |
| He is my cousin brother. | He is my cousin.                             |
| Do one thing...          | Let's do this... / Here's what...            |
| It is very much hot.     | It is very hot.                              |

**Why they happen:** direct translation from Hindi (e.g. "Aapka shubh naam kya hai?" → "What is your good name?"), residual British-English influence from colonial times, and overuse of certain formal phrases.

**Exam tip:** Always choose the simpler, more direct, standard option.

### Related corrections practised:

| Original                                                | Correction / Note                                                                                                              |
|---------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| I joined TCS five years before.                         | I joined TCS five years <b>ago</b> . ("ago" counts back from now; "before" counts back from another past event.)               |
| I reach by office by 8 am. / I will recay office by 8m. | I reach office by 8 am. (habit) / I will reach office by 8 am. (future)                                                        |
| ...prepone our call by 2 hours...                       | ...advance our call by 2 hours... ("prepone" is an Indianism; use "advance" or "move earlier" in global/professional English.) |

### Practice: Spot-the-mistake (video clip transcript)

- "Miss Indian" → should be "Miss India" (proper name)
- "...me, we're..." → should be "Miss India and I" (subject pronoun)
- "I just can't be able to understand" → double phrasing; say "I just can't" or "I am not able to"
- "I told already" → should be "I already told you" (missing object)
- "Let me say you something" → wrong verb; should be "Let me tell you something"
- "check on the work" → should be "check the work" (no "on" needed)
- "Wellness Inde" → garbled; should be "Well, Mister Indian"

- "I've rowed thousands of males" → should be "I've written thousands of mails"
- "they are all understanding" → wrong tense for a general fact; should be "they all understand"

**Total mistakes found: 9**

## 5. Qualifiers

Words that weaken or strengthen another word (usually an adjective/adverb). They answer: "To what extent?" or "How much?"

| Strengtheners (intensifiers)                                  | Weakeners (downtoners)                                   |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| very, extremely, absolutely, completely, totally, really, too | quite, rather, somewhat, a bit, fairly, slightly, hardly |

### When to use qualifiers:

- To be precise — *The movie was quite interesting.*
- To be polite/diplomatic — *Your work is somewhat incomplete.*
- To avoid overstatement — *I am rather tired.*
- To show degree — *She is very talented.*

**Exam tip — avoid overusing "very":** ■ very big → ■ huge | ■ very small → ■ tiny | ■ very good → ■ excellent

## 6. Few vs. A Few | Little vs. A Little

| Phrase   | Meaning & Example                                            |
|----------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Few      | Almost none / not many — <b>negative</b> (Few people came.)  |
| A few    | Some / a small number — <b>positive</b> (A few people came.) |
| Little   | Almost none — <b>negative</b> (I have little time.)          |
| A little | Some — <b>positive</b> (I have a little time.)               |

**Memory trick:** Few = Forget it (not enough) | A few = Accept it (enough)

## 7. Colloquial Forms & Graded Quantifiers

**Colloquial forms — informal spoken language; avoid in formal writing/exams.**

| Formal            | Colloquial    |
|-------------------|---------------|
| I am going to     | I'm gonna     |
| I want to         | I wanna       |
| Let me            | Lemme         |
| Give me           | Gimme         |
| Have got to       | Gotta         |
| Kind of / Sort of | Kinda / Sorta |

**Graded quantifiers — show amount on a scale from 0% to 100%.**

| Amount        | Quantifiers                                 |
|---------------|---------------------------------------------|
| 100%          | all, every, whole                           |
| Large amount  | many, much, a lot of, plenty of, most       |
| Medium amount | several, some, quite a few, a number of     |
| Small amount  | a few, a little, a couple of, not many/much |
| Almost zero   | few, little, hardly any, scarcely any       |
| Zero          | no, none, not any                           |

**Graded** quantifiers can combine with very/more/less (very many). **Non-graded** ones cannot (■ very all, ■ more every).

## 8. Some / Any / Enough

| Word   | Used in... (example)                                                                        |
|--------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Some   | Positive statements, offers, requests — <i>I have some money. Would you like some tea?</i>  |
| Any    | Negative statements & questions — <i>I don't have any money. Do you have any questions?</i> |
| Enough | Sufficiency (positive/negative/questions) — <i>We have enough time. She is tall enough.</i> |

**Memory trick:** *Some* = yes (positive) | *Any* = no/question (negative/interrogative) | *Enough* = sufficient amount

### Practice — choose the correct quantifier

1. There is \_\_\_\_\_ talk of increase in salaries in our office.

Options: more | some

✓ **Answer: some**

We use "some" in positive statements like this.

2. There is \_\_\_\_\_ time to complete the work.

Options: little | a little

✓ **Answer: little**

Implies "not enough time" — negative sense.

3. There is \_\_\_\_\_ information on the Internet.

Options: a great deal of | too much

✓ **Answer: a great deal of**

Large amount in a neutral/positive sense; "too much" implies excess.

4. There is \_\_\_\_\_ evidence to show that work hours are longer today than a decade ago.

Options: little | a little

✓ **Answer: little**

Implies "not enough / hardly any" — negative sense.

5. There is \_\_\_\_\_ room in the car.

Options: a great deal of | plenty of

✓ **Answer: plenty of**

"Plenty of" is more natural for physical space.



## 9. Articles — A / An / The

| Article      | Meaning / Usage                                                                         |
|--------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A / An       | Indefinite — general, one of many. "A" before consonant sound, "an" before vowel sound. |
| The          | Definite — specific, particular one both speaker & listener know.                       |
| (No article) | Zero article — general plural/uncountable nouns, names, meals, languages, sports.       |

### Common mistakes

| Wrong                              | Correct                                        |
|------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| I have a important meeting.        | I have an important meeting.                   |
| She is the doctor. (first mention) | She is a doctor.                               |
| I go to the school every day.      | I go to school every day. (purpose, not place) |
| He plays the cricket.              | He plays cricket. (sports — no article)        |
| I love the music.                  | I love music. (general — no article)           |

### Tricky examples

| Example                                    | Explanation                                             |
|--------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| A cat is an animal.                        | First mention / general category                        |
| The cat on the roof is mine.               | Specific cat (both know which)                          |
| He went to the hospital to visit a friend. | As a place (not as a patient)                           |
| He went to hospital. (British)             | As a patient — no article                               |
| The rich should help the poor.             | "The + adjective" = a group of people                   |
| I have the flu. / I have a cold.           | Some illnesses take "the" (flu), others take "a" (cold) |

## 10. Linkers (Transition Words / Connectors)

Words that connect ideas to show their relationship, making writing/speech smooth and logical.

| Function        | Common Linkers                                 |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Addition        | and, also, moreover, furthermore, in addition  |
| Contrast        | but, however, although, though, whereas, while |
| Cause / Reason  | because, since, as, due to                     |
| Result / Effect | so, therefore, thus, hence, consequently       |
| Purpose         | to, in order to, so that                       |
| Sequence / Time | first, then, next, finally, after, before      |
| Condition       | if, unless, provided that                      |
| Example         | for example, for instance, such as             |
| Emphasis        | indeed, in fact, especially                    |
| Summary         | in conclusion, to sum up, overall              |

### Punctuation rules

| Linker Position                              | Rule                                               |
|----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| However, moreover, therefore, consequently   | Comma after: I was tired. However, I worked.       |
| Although, because, since (start of sentence) | Comma after clause: Although it rained, we played. |
| Because, since (in the middle)               | No comma: We stayed home because it rained.        |

**Memory trick:** Linkers = glue that sticks ideas together. Without: I was tired. I worked. With: I was tired, but I worked.

## 11. Modifiers, Adjuncts, Phrases & Clauses

**Modifier** = a word (or group of words) that gives extra detail about another word — like a decorator. *I saw a dog* → *I saw a black dog / a dog running fast.*

| Type               | Example                                                            |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Adjective modifier | Describes a noun — <i>beautiful painting, tall man</i>             |
| Adverb modifier    | Describes a verb/adjective/adverb — <i>ran quickly, very smart</i> |

**Careful:** ■ *She runs quick.* ■ *She runs quickly.*

### Adjunct — a removable modifier

An adjunct is a modifier that is **not essential**; remove it and the sentence still makes sense. e.g. *She sings beautifully* → *She sings.* (still fine)

*All adjuncts are modifiers, but not all modifiers are adjuncts.*

### Phrases as modifiers

| Phrase Type          | Example                                            |
|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Prepositional phrase | The cat on the roof is mine. (modifies "cat")      |
| Infinitive phrase    | She came to help me. (modifies "came" — tells why) |
| Participial phrase   | Running fast, he won the race. (modifies "he")     |
| Adjective phrase     | She is very intelligent. (modifies "she")          |
| Adverb phrase        | He drives very carefully. (modifies "drives")      |

### Clauses as modifiers (have a subject + verb)

| Clause Type                 | Example                                                       |
|-----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Adjective / relative clause | The man who called you is my brother. (modifies "man")        |
| Adverb clause               | She left because she was tired. (modifies "left" — tells why) |

**Key difference:** a phrase has no subject-verb (*on the roof*); a clause does (*who is on the roof*).

### Restrictive vs. Non-restrictive modifiers

| Type            | Meaning & Example                                                         |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Restrictive     | Essential — no commas — <i>The student who cheated was punished.</i>      |
| Non-restrictive | Extra info — commas — <i>My brother, who lives in Delhi, is a doctor.</i> |

## 12. Pronouns

A pronoun replaces a noun to avoid repetition. e.g. Riya is a doctor. She works hard.

| Type          | Examples                                                             |
|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Personal      | I, you, he, she, it, we, they, me, him, her, us, them                |
| Possessive    | my, your, his, her, its, our, their, mine, yours, hers, ours, theirs |
| Reflexive     | myself, yourself, himself, herself, itself, ourselves, themselves    |
| Demonstrative | this, that, these, those                                             |
| Interrogative | who, whom, whose, which, what                                        |
| Relative      | who, whom, which, that, whose                                        |
| Indefinite    | someone, anyone, nobody, everybody, few, many, all, none             |
| Reciprocal    | each other, one another                                              |

### Common mistakes

| Wrong                          | Correct                                            |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Me and Riya went out.          | Riya and I went out. (subject → "I")               |
| She gave it to I.              | She gave it to me. (object → "me")                 |
| This is my book. This is your. | This is yours. (possessive pronoun, no noun after) |

**Memory trick:** Pronoun = Pro (for) + Noun = a word used in place of a noun.

# TCS English Assessment

Complete question bank with reading passages, options and correct answers, organised by section

## Section A — Idiomatic Expressions

Passage-based questions

**Passage:** There are various categories of idiomatic expressions based on their structure, composition and meaning. These categories are, however, not exhaustive — classification might vary according to the parameters used. An **idiom** is an expression with a figurative meaning, different from the literal meaning of its individual components, generally accepted by convention. E.g. "done to death" and "dip my toe in the water" are used figuratively, not literally. Interestingly, many idioms began as literal expressions — "burning the midnight oil" originally meant literally burning oil in a lamp to work at night before electricity existed; over time it became figurative for working late/hard. Idioms originate from everyday life — food, colours, animals, body parts.

**1. What does "burning the midnight oil" refer to?**

Options: Work hard / stay up late to finish a task | Lighting a lamp to complete work | Setting fire to something | Working during power cuts

✓ **Answer: Work hard or stay up late in the night to complete a task at hand**

**2. What does "done to death" mean in: "...a topic that has perhaps been done to death"?**

Options: Repeated many times | Dead | Irrelevant | Extinct

✓ **Answer: Repeated many times**

**3. According to the text, which is true about idioms?**

Options: Idioms are exhaustive | Idioms can be used both literally and figuratively | Idioms can be understood from individual words | Idioms are the most popular idiomatic expressions

✓ **Answer: Idioms can be used both literally and figuratively**

**4. What is the purpose of the text?**

Options: Describes types of idiomatic expressions | Describes types of idioms | Introduces idiomatic expressions & lists categories | Introduces idioms and their characteristics

✓ **Answer: Introduces idioms and their characteristics**

**5. Which statement is NOT true about idiomatic expressions?**

Options: Can be divided into various categories | Are divided into fixed categories | Have different structure, composition and meaning | Are divided based on different parameters

✓ **Answer: Idiomatic expressions are divided into fixed categories**

## Section B — Locus of Control

Audio / transcript-based questions

**Passage (transcript):** This examines the cultural concept of locus of control, comparing Indian and Western societies. Societies with an **external** locus of control focus on others/colleagues/extended family rather than self (internal locus). External-locus corruption tends to be shame-based; internal-locus corruption tends to be guilt-based. External-locus societies show less initiative-taking but more harmony-building, and a tendency to "go with the flow" — submitting to a sense of fate planned by an external authority. Indians traditionally have an external locus of control socially; children are corrected with comments like "What will the neighbours say?" — in the US, a child would instead simply be told to avoid the behaviour in future (internal locus). Professional Indians, especially in high-tech careers, develop an internal-locus approach and can switch between the two approaches by context without this being hypocritical. Indians have become risk-takers as a survival skill, though this risk-taking tendency is not as sharply honed as that of many Americans.

### 6. Comparing risk-taking tendencies of Americans and Indians, which is true?

Options: Both have similar risk-taking tendencies | American risk-taking is more sharply honed than Indians' | Indians are open-minded to ambiguity but Americans are not

✓ **Answer: The risk-taking ability of Americans is more sharply honed than that of Indians**

### 7. People with an external locus of control "go with the flow" because:

Options: They prefer building harmony | They are less initiative-taking | They give in to a sense of fate planned by an external authority

✓ **Answer: They give in to a sense of fate planned by an external authority**

### 8. Which characterizes Indians re: locus of control?

Options: All Indians have an external locus of control | Indians can switch between approaches depending on context | Switching between approaches is hypocritical for Indians

✓ **Answer: Indians have an ability to switch between one approach to other depending on the environment/context they are in**

### 9. Which is NOT true of external-locus-of-control societies?

Options: They tend to focus on self | They tend to correct others frequently | They tend to focus on others — colleagues and extended family

✓ **Answer: They tend to focus on self**

### 10. How is a US child likely admonished for negative behaviour?

Options: Asked to stand in the corner and reflect | Asked to avoid such behaviour in future | Asked to consider what neighbours would say

✓ **Answer: He/she will be asked to avoid such behaviour in the future**

## Section C — Indian English vs. Standard English

### 11. Choose the only correct sentence:

Options: Just dance on his head till it is done. | Just sit on his head and get it done. | Just breathe down his neck and get it done.

✓ Answer: **Just breathe down his neck and get it done.**

### 12. Choose the only correct sentence:

Options: The RFP has turned out too well. | The RFP has turned out very well. | The RFP has turned out very much well.

✓ Answer: **The RFP has turned out very well.**

### 13. True or False: "Please do the needful."

Options: TRUE | FALSE

✓ Answer: **FALSE**

### 14. True or False: "Please could you repeat again?"

Options: TRUE | FALSE

✓ Answer: **FALSE**

## Section D — Fill in the Blanks: Email / Paragraph

**Passage:** Dear coordinator, During the week from the 6th to the 13th of December, I \_\_\_\_\_(1) my brother's wedding in my home country. At first I would like to know if it \_\_\_\_\_(2) possible for me to leave during the week referred. I \_\_\_\_\_(3) internet connection at home, and I \_\_\_\_\_(4) my e-mail regularly. In case of emergency, you \_\_\_\_\_(5) me on these numbers. We can also \_\_\_\_\_(6) an online meeting if necessary. My co-worker Julia, \_\_\_\_\_(7) in charge of my duties during the time I'm away. We \_\_\_\_\_(8) details of my activities during the week before my departure. Regards, xxxxxx

### 15. Blank 1

Options: am attending | will be attending | attend | attended

✓ Answer: **will be attending**

### 16. Blank 2

Options: is | was | were | will be

✓ Answer: **is**

### 17. Blank 3

Options: have received | have | had | will have

✓ Answer: **have**

### 18. Blank 4

Options: will check | check | checked | have checked

✓ Answer: **will check**

### 19. Blank 5

Options: will contact | contact | can contact | contacted

✓ Answer: **will contact (or can contact — both acceptable)**

### 20. Blank 6

Options: schedule | arrange | have | do

✓ Answer: **schedule / arrange (both acceptable)**

**21. Blank 7**

Options: is | will be | was | has been

✓ **Answer: will be**

**22. Blank 8**

Options: will discuss | discuss | discussed | have discussed

✓ **Answer: will discuss**



## Section E — Correct Sentence / Grammar

### 23. Which is the correct sentence?

Options: Why did you not tell him that you had had an accident? | Why you did not tell him that you had had an accident?

✓ **Answer: Why did you not tell him that you had had an accident?**

### 24. Which is the correct sentence?

Options: I usually leave office at 6 p.m. | I leave office usually at 6 p.m.

✓ **Answer: I usually leave office at 6 p.m.**

### 25. Which is correct?

Options: He has been working in TCS since 2012. | He has been working since 2012 in TCS.

✓ **Answer: He has been working in TCS since 2012.**

## Section F — Confusing Words (Homophones)

### 26. Do you think I am \_\_\_\_? I have a lot of work.

Options: idol | idle | ideal

✓ **Answer: idle**

### 27. The company is going to \_\_\_\_ a new policy for health insurance.

Options: adapt | adept | adopt

✓ **Answer: adopt**

### 28. They had to \_\_\_\_ the building and build it from scratch.

Options: raise | rise | raze

✓ **Answer: raze**

## Section G — Paraphrasing / Meaning

### 29. "In 2014, TCS broke ground as the first company to start an all-woman call center." — Correct paraphrase?

Options: While this has already been done in the past, TCS was the first to start it in 2014. | An all-woman call center was started for the first time in the year 2014.

✓ **Answer: An all-woman call center was started for the first time in the year 2014.**

### 30. "Users who frequently log in late face this problem." — What does this mean?

Options: Ambiguous — "frequently" can modify either "log in late" or "face this problem" | All users who log in late frequently face this problem — "frequently" modifies "users who log in late"

✓ **Answer: The meaning of the sentence is ambiguous, as the word "frequently" is placed in such a manner that it can modify either "Users who log in late..." or "... face this problem".**

### 31. "TCS broke ground as the first company to start an all-woman call center in 2014." — Correct paraphrase?

Options: While this has already been done in the past, TCS was the first to start it in 2014. | An all-woman call center was started for the first time in the year 2014.

✓ **Answer: An all-woman call center was started for the first time in the year 2014.**

## Section H — Articles (Fill in the Blanks)

**Passage:** The participants might have had some problems in understanding (1)\_\_\_\_\_ American accent of the speakers in each exercise. The Faculty can reassure the participants that concerted practice can bring about (2)\_\_\_\_\_ familiarization and ease in understanding (3)\_\_\_\_\_ speech of people from other countries. This is very significant as preparation for communicating with (4)\_\_\_\_\_ customers from native English speaking regions of the world.

### 32. Blank 1

Options: a | an | the

✓ Answer: the

### 33. Blank 2

Options: a | an | the | no article

✓ Answer: no article

### 34. Blank 3

Options: a | an | the

✓ Answer: the

### 35. Blank 4

Options: a | an | the | no article

✓ Answer: no article

## Section I — Fill in the Blanks: Various

### 36. \_\_\_\_\_ I would like to learn is advanced Java.

Options: What | That | Which | Who

✓ Answer: What

### 37. \_\_\_\_\_ associates in our company are from North India.

Options: A number of | A great deal of

✓ Answer: A number of

### 38. He knows \_\_\_\_\_ about computers than any of his colleagues.

Options: more | most | much | many

✓ Answer: more

### 39. Don't let \_\_\_\_\_ in. I am busy.

Options: someone | anyone | no one | everyone

✓ Answer: anyone

### 40. Both products will work. Both can be relied \_\_\_\_\_.

Options: on | upon | at | for

✓ Answer: upon (or on)

### 41. \_\_\_\_\_ you are taking over from Jim, could you please handle any future correspondence related to this account?

Options: Since | Thus | But | Hence

✓ Answer: Since

### 42. James likes presentations to be simple yet visually appealing \_\_\_\_\_. Harry prefers presentations to be informative.

Options: unlike | whereas | in the same way | since

✓ **Answer: whereas**

**43. Debbie is collating all the data for the team. \_\_\_\_\_, she will also calculate the metrics.**

Options: Otherwise | Whereas | However | Furthermore

✓ **Answer: Furthermore**

## Section J — Subject-Verb Agreement

44. The Annual report, together with some other points that are awaiting action, \_\_\_\_\_ the main agenda in this meeting.

Options: is | are

✓ Answer: is

45. Neither of these choices \_\_\_\_\_ to be satisfactory.

Options: appears | appear

✓ Answer: appears

## Section K — Conversation Fill-in-the-Blanks

**Passage:** Ruchi: You are a far \_\_\_\_\_(1) programmer than I am. Rahul: True. But I don't think I could write half the reports \_\_\_\_\_(2) you can! Ruchi: Well, I don't write as \_\_\_\_\_(3) as I used to. Rahul: \_\_\_\_\_(4) you still enjoy writing, don't you?

46. Blank 1

Options: better | good | best | well

✓ Answer: better

47. Blank 2

Options: that | but | nearly | better

✓ Answer: that

48. Blank 3

Options: better | that | well | or

✓ Answer: well

49. Blank 4

Options: But | So | Because | Although

✓ Answer: But

## Section L — Relative Pronouns

50. This is the lady \_\_\_\_\_ we were speaking.

Options: who | whom | which | that

✓ Answer: whom

51. The man you spoke to is the one \_\_\_\_\_ got the job.

Options: who | whom | which | whose

✓ Answer: who

# Practice Exercises

Fill-in-the-blank drills from the TCS iON Digital Learning module — attempt first, then check the answer key a

## Exercise 1 — Dependent Prepositions (Conversation)

Source: TCS iON Digital Learning — Dependent Prepositions, Part III, Exercise 1. Fill each blank with the correct preposition from the options given.

**Conversation:** Sanjay: Do come in, Pooja.

Pooja: I must apologize \_\_\_(1)\_\_\_ being late. The Mumbai traffic, as you know, cannot be predicted.

Sanjay: Please don't worry \_\_\_(2)\_\_\_ that. The meeting stands cancelled. Do help yourself \_\_\_(3)\_\_\_ some coffee.

Oh, and lest I forget — Congratulations \_\_\_(4)\_\_\_ your new assignment.

Pooja: Thank you, Sanjay. However, since it's not official yet, please keep it \_\_\_(5)\_\_\_ yourself for a bit.

Sanjay: Certainly. When are you thinking \_\_\_(6)\_\_\_ taking up the new job?

Pooja: I'm not sure. It will depend \_\_\_(7)\_\_\_ the contract. I am a little nervous — I am not sure if I am sufficiently qualified \_\_\_(8)\_\_\_ the job.

Sanjay: Nonsense! Everyone has a lot of confidence \_\_\_(9)\_\_\_ your ability to deliver. You are going to be a big success \_\_\_(10)\_\_\_ our Norwegian clients.

Pooja: Sanjay, when does your present assignment come \_\_\_(11)\_\_\_ a close?

### Fill in the blanks (options given for each):

1. Blank (1): apologize \_\_\_ being late

( for / about / on )

2. Blank (2): don't worry \_\_\_ that

( about / for / on )

3. Blank (3): help yourself \_\_\_ some coffee

( to / with / for )

4. Blank (4): Congratulations \_\_\_ your new assignment

( on / for / about )

5. Blank (5): keep it \_\_\_ yourself

( to / for / with )

6. Blank (6): thinking \_\_\_ taking up the new job

( of / about / on )

7. Blank (7): depend \_\_\_ the contract

( on / upon / with )

8. Blank (8): sufficiently qualified \_\_\_ the job

( for / to / in )

9. Blank (9): confidence \_\_\_ your ability

( in / on / with )

**10. Blank (10): a big success \_\_\_\_ our Norwegian clients**

( with / to / for )

**11. Blank (11): assignment come \_\_\_\_ a close**

( to / in / at )

### Answer Key — Exercise 1

|        |          |        |        |
|--------|----------|--------|--------|
| 1. for | 2. about | 3. to  | 4. on  |
| 5. to  | 6. of    | 7. on  | 8. for |
| 9. in  | 10. with | 11. to |        |

## Exercise 2 — Dependent Prepositions (Common Phrases)

Source: TCS iON Digital Learning — Dependent Prepositions, Part III, Exercise 2. Choose the correct preposition to complete each fixed phrase.

1. To rely \_\_\_\_ something or someone

( on / upon / with / for )

2. To have confidence \_\_\_\_ something or someone

( in / on / with / for )

3. To find it difficult \_\_\_\_ do something

( to / in / for / with )

4. To help \_\_\_\_ any way possible

( in / to / with / for )

5. To help oneself \_\_\_\_ something

( to / with / in / for )

6. To worry \_\_\_\_ something or someone

( about / for / on / with )

7. To depend \_\_\_\_ something or someone

( on / upon / to / with )

8. To keep something \_\_\_\_ oneself

( to / with / for / in )

### Answer Key — Exercise 2

|       |          |       |       |
|-------|----------|-------|-------|
| 1. on | 2. in    | 3. to | 4. in |
| 5. to | 6. about | 7. on | 8. to |

## Exercise 3 — Relative Pronouns

Source: TCS iON Digital Learning — CLI Grammar Nuggets: Pronouns, Game 1. Choose the correct relative pronoun (who / which / whom / whose / that) for each blank.

1. Where is your colleague \_\_\_\_ was supposed to meet us?

( who / which / whom / whose )

2. I met the CEO of the company \_\_\_\_ makes hybrid cars.

( which / who / whom / whose )

3. This is my friend \_\_\_\_ brother is in the USA.

( whose / who / which / whom )

4. The person \_\_\_\_ spoke to me just now works in a bank.

( who / which / whom / whose )

5. The laptop \_\_\_\_ I used yesterday is malfunctioning today.

( which / who / whom / whose )

6. I can't remember the name of the movie \_\_\_\_ we saw.

( which / who / whom / that )

7. The book \_\_\_\_ won the Booker prize, is very interesting.

( which / who / whom / whose )

8. Many friends \_\_\_\_ opinion I value, have praised my book.

( whose / who / which / whom )

9. The man of \_\_\_\_ I was speaking, is fond of trekking.

( whom / who / which / whose )

10. \_\_\_\_ is the building I work in.

( That / Who / Whom / Whose )

11. The lady you just met is the one \_\_\_\_ heads this project.

( who / which / whom / whose )

12. The friend \_\_\_\_ car I am using has gone to France.

( whose / who / which / whom )

### Answer Key — Exercise 3

|          |          |          |           |
|----------|----------|----------|-----------|
| 1. who   | 2. which | 3. whose | 4. who    |
| 5. which | 6. which | 7. which | 8. whose  |
| 9. whom  | 10. that | 11. who  | 12. whose |



**Quick reference — relative pronoun choice:**

- **who** — subject, for people
- **whom** — object, for people (often after a preposition: "of whom", "to whom")
- **which** — for things/animals
- **whose** — possessive, for people or things
- **that** — for people or things (restrictive clauses; also used for a general subject like "That is the building...")